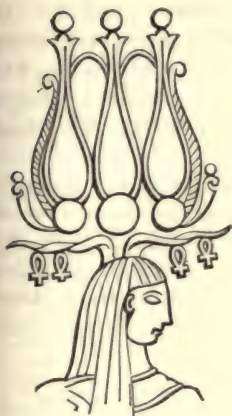
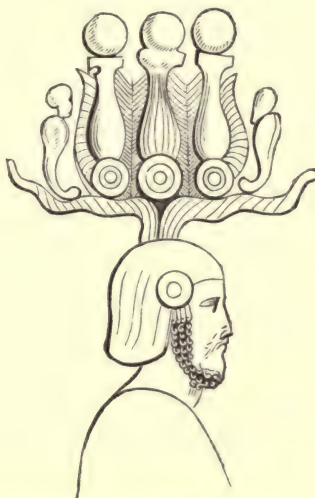


know this goddess,⁴ whom the Arabians call Alitta,⁵ and the Persians Mitra.⁶



1. Egyptian.



2. Persian.

⁴ For a full notice of this goddess, see below, Essay x. 'On the Religion of the Assyrians and Babylonians.' The true explanation of the Herodotean nomenclature, which has been so much discussed, seems to be, that Molis (as Nic. Damasc. gives the name, *Fragm. Hist. Gr.*, vol. iii. p. 361, note 16) is for *Volis*, and that *Volis* is identical with the Chaldean *Gula*, the *g* and *v* being (as is well known) perpetually liable to confusion in the Greek orthography of Oriental names. In *Mylitta* we probably have the same name with a feminine ending. *Gula* in the primitive language of Babylonia, which is now ascertained to be of the Hamitic, and not of the Semitic family, signified "great," being either identical with *Gal* (the more ordinary term for "great"—compare *Ner-gal*, *Ṣad-gal*, *Gallus*, &c.), or a feminine form of that word,—answering in fact to the *Guda* of the Galla dialect of Africa. *Gula* is the standard name for the *Great Goddess* throughout the Inscriptions. *Bilat*, or *Beltis*, simply meaning "a lady or mistress," was probably an Assyrian epithet for the same goddess; but if the name were translated by the Assyrians, as was usually the case with the old Hamitic denominations, the equivalent would have been *Rabbat*, as in Syriac it was *Gadlat*, and in Persian *Maha Bag*, which latter compound was contracted to *Mabog*, as the name of the seat of the Great Goddess's worship at Hierapolis. *Gula*, or the Great Goddess, is quite distinct from *Ishtar* or *Astarté*.—[H. C. R.]



Mylitta, the "Great Goddess" of the Assyrians.
(From Layard.)

⁵ Alitta, or Alilat (iii. 8), is the Semitic root אל, "God," with the feminine suffix, ת, or נת, added.

⁶ This identification is altogether a mistake. The Persians, like their Vedio